GLASSHOUSE

STORM AND A TEACUP

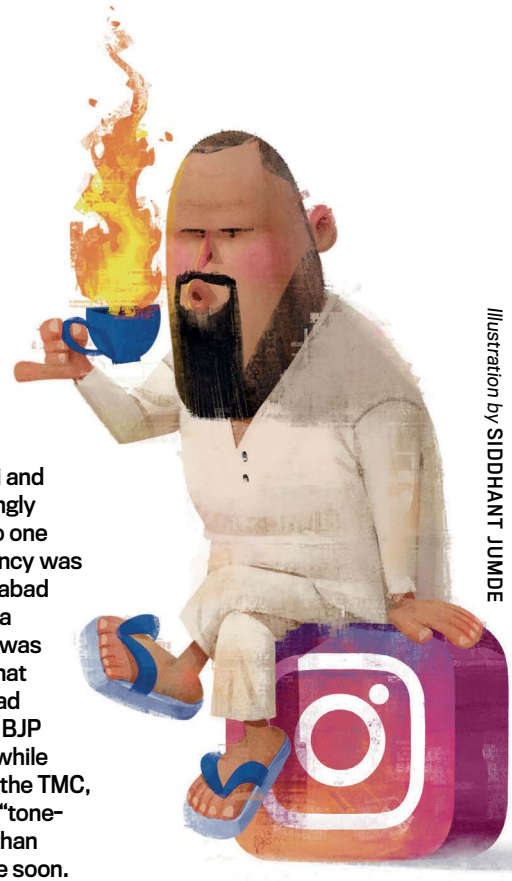


Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

The mobs were running amok, but ex-cricketer and Behrampore MP Yusuf Pathan figured it was time for an Instagram interlude. "Easy afternoons, good chai and calm surroundings," he mused, seemingly worlds away from the mayhem. But no one was amused. The TMC MP's constituency was spared the bloodshed, but as Murshidabad district's administrative nerve centre, a show of leadership, or even empathy, was the bare minimum needed. Instead, what the public got was a three-photo spread of Pathan's quest for inner peace. The BJP pounced, accusing him of sipping tea while "Hindus got slaughtered". Even within the TMC, the murmurs grew louder—"outsider," "tone-deaf," "Insta disaster"... Looks like Pathan won't be up for 'Impact Player' anytime soon.

Believe in Uncle



When ex-Union minister Ashwini Choubey remarked on April 10 that he would personally fancy Nitish Kumar in the deputy prime minister's chair, the comment was received as an artful barb, sparking more buzz that the BJP was quietly plotting to sideline the Bihar CM this election year. Then, adding another twist to the political farce, on April 14, Nitish's son **Nishant Kumar** insisted that even "Amit [Shah] uncle," had spoken about "*pitaji* being the CM face again". Now if 'Uncle' has spoken, guess it's locked till at least after the polls. Or is it?

Secular Slide



The Biju Janata Dal (BJD) is battling some major inner demons these days. Eight-time MLA **Ranendra Pratap Swain** has penned a heartfelt missive to party boss Naveen Patnaik—part plea, part passive-aggressive post-it note. Swain's gripe? A select few were allegedly hijacking the party machinery while the rest sipped tea in quiet despair. He's particularly concerned about the BJD, once the torchbearer of secularism and social justice, siding with the ruling BJP on controversial matters like the Waqf (Amendment) Bill. Of course, party loyalists responded with the usual hand-wringing. "Let the process finish," they said, as if democracy were an unfinished jigsaw puzzle.

MARKS AND MINISTERS



A political slugfest erupted after Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav and AAP convenor Arvind Kejriwal slammed the 'Gujarat model', just that it was a year-old report saying that not a single student from 157 schools had cleared the Class 10 Board exams. But what raised eyebrows wasn't the criticism, it was the counterattack. Instead of state education minister Kuber Dindor, it was MoS for home **Harsh Sanghavi** who led the defence with combative tweets and press statements. His 'out-of-turn' actions have started fuelling chatter within the BJP about the rising 'clout' of the young Surat MLA.

THE QUEEN ROARS

She has been quiet, but **Vasundhara Raje** can still make the ground shake. Last week in Jhalawar—her bastion and son Dushyant's Lok Sabha turf—the former Rajasthan CM snapped. Women were complaining of dry taps. Raje tore into the officials over missing Jal Jeevan Mission funds and posted a stinger online: "Don't the people feel thirsty? Or is it only the officials who do?" The post lit a fire. Union Jal Shakti minister C.R. Patil ordered a probe. Rajasthan CM Bhajan Lal Sharma summoned PHED officials. State BJP chief Madan Lal Rathore too waded in. Meanwhile, Chief Secretary Sudhansh Pant lashed out at Karauli collector Neelabh Saxena for skipping town mid-crisis—on "urgent work" in Lucknow, he had dialled into the water review remotely. "If I knew he was chilling at a hill station, that leave would've never been approved," Pant snapped.



ANI

Kaushik Deka with Arkamoy Datta Majumdar, Rohit Parihar, Jumana Shah and Amitabh Srivastava